

Opening / general reflection

- What just happened in that shift, in your own words?
- What are you most pleased with from that shift?
- What would you do differently if you ran that shift again?
- What surprised you?
- Where did the pressure bite hardest, and what did you do with it?
- What was the hardest single decision, and why?
- If you had to sum that shift up in one word, what would it be?
- What did that shift ask of you that the last one did not?

Priorities and focus

- What did you decide to lead with this shift, and why that?
- What did you consciously choose *not* to focus on?
- How did you decide what could wait?
- Looking back, was your priority the right one for what the store actually needed?
- What pulled your attention first when the shift opened?
- Did your priority hold all shift, or did it move? What moved it?
- What would have had to be true for you to choose a different focus?

Action and approach (act vs observe)

- Did you act quickly, or take time to read the situation first?
 - How did that serve you?
- When did you decide you had enough information to act?
- Where did you jump in when you could have watched a little longer, or the reverse?
- What is the cost of waiting in a shift like that?
 - What is the cost of acting too soon?
- Was there a moment you wish you had paused before acting?

Leadership style

- How did you choose to lead your team this shift?
- What did you want your team to feel by the end of that shift?
- How do you think your team experienced the way you led?
- Did your style fit the shift, or did you default to how you usually lead?
- When did you feel the urge to take more control, or to let go more?
- What would leading that shift the opposite way have cost you?
- Which of your people needed a different approach from the rest?

Resource allocation and trade-offs

- How did you decide where to put your people?
- What did you starve in order to feed something else?
- What was the trade-off you found hardest to make?
- If you had one more pair of hands, where would they have gone?
 - What does that tell you?
- Did your split of effort match the priority you set, or did they pull apart?
- What did you protect, even under pressure?

The people moment

- What do you think that person actually needed from you?
- What were they not saying?
- How confident are you they left that conversation with what they needed?
- What did your response teach them about how to bring you a problem?
- Would you handle that person the same way if the store were calmer?
- What did attending to that person cost you elsewhere, and was it worth it?
- When one of your team comes to you mid-crisis, what is your instinct?
 - How did it serve you here?

Confidence and risk appetite

- How sure were you of your plan when you committed to it?
- What told you it was a shift to press forward, or one to hold back?
- When has backing yourself hard paid off, and when has it caught you out?
- What would you have needed to see to be bolder, or more cautious?
- Did your confidence match the situation, or your mood?
- How did the rest of the team feel about how much you were willing to stake?

Disruptions and the unexpected

- When it broke, what was the first thing you did?
- How did the disruption change your plan, if at all?
- What did you drop to deal with it, and did you pick it back up?
- How did you keep the team steady when things went sideways?
- Did the disruption reveal anything about how you lead under real pressure?
- What did a shift with no disruption tempt you to do differently? (for clean shifts)
- How ready were you for something to go wrong before it did?

Reading the store / instinct vs data

- What were the numbers telling you, and did you believe them?
- Where did your gut and the data disagree, and who won?
- What did you notice that the dashboard could not show you?
- What did you miss that was there to be seen?
- How much of your decision was evidence, and how much was instinct?

The handover (the unreliable narrator)

- How much did you trust the handover you were given?
- Where did what you found differ from what you were told?
- What did the previous manager get right, and what did they not?
- At what point did you stop leaning on the handover and start trusting the floor?
- If you were writing the handover for the next manager, what would you be honest about that this one was not?

Team dynamics (you shared the decisions)

- How did you make those calls as a group?
- Who ended up driving the decisions, and how did that happen?
- Whose view did not get heard, and what might you have missed because of it?
- How did you handle it when you disagreed?
- Did sharing the decision make it better, slower, or both?
- Was there a call you made together that no one individually would have made?
- How did the way you worked as a team change from the start of the shift to the end?

Emotion and pressure

- Where did you feel the pressure most, physically or mentally?
- What was going through your head at the busiest moment?
- Did you stay the leader you wanted to be when it got hard?
- What tends to happen to your judgement when the pressure rises?
- How did you look after yourself, and each other, during that shift?

Self-awareness and patterns (strong after later shifts)

- What is becoming a pattern in how you lead these shifts?
- What do you keep coming back to, shift after shift?
- What have you changed since the first shift, and why?
- What does this shift confirm about how you lead, and what does it challenge?
- Where are you growing more comfortable, and where are you still avoiding?
- If someone watched all your shifts back-to-back, how would they describe your leadership signature?

Transfer to the real workplace

- Where have you seen a shift like that in your real store?
- What did that shift remind you of from your own team?
- What is one thing from that shift you will try differently on Monday?
- Who on your real team does that person you just handled remind you of?
- What would your own manager have made of how you led that?
- What is the smallest change from today that would make the biggest difference back at work?